Ready-to-drink cold brew: launch proposal

Brightline Coffee Co. · Board memo · Prepared by Strategy & Finance · October 2026 · Confidential (fictional sample)

1. Recommendation

We propose launching a canned ready-to-drink (RTD) cold brew line in 2026, sold through regional grocery chains in our four store regions, starting in the West where in-store cold brew is strongest. The launch budget is **$2.5 million**, covering co-packer setup, packaging, first production runs, slotting fees and launch marketing.

2. Why now

In-store iced and cold brew has been our fastest-growing line over the last two years (see the attached sales export), while hot coffee is flat to declining. Our team estimates the U.S. RTD coffee market at **about $5.2 billion in 2025, growing roughly 9% a year**, with cold brew the fastest-growing segment. *These figures come from a 2024 trade-press summary and have not been re-checked.*

3. Unit economics (draft)

Assumption	Value
Can size	11 fl oz
Landed unit cost at co-packer (liquid, can, freight)	$1.15
Distributor and retailer share of shelf price	45%
Target gross margin on our net revenue	at least 35%
Planned volume after ramp-up	120,000–180,000 cans / month
Payback target on the launch budget	under 24 months

Shelf price is open. The attached photo shows what competing cans cost at a partner grocery store in September 2026.

4. Questions for the board

1. Are the market size and growth assumptions in section 2 still right?
2. What shelf price clears a 35% gross margin, and is it competitive?
3. At planned volumes, how long until the $2.5 million is paid back?
4. Which region should launch first, based on our own cold brew sales?

5. Risks

Shelf competition from national brands with larger marketing budgets; co-packer minimum runs that exceed early demand; cannibalisation of in-store cold brew; and slotting fees above the budgeted $400,000.

Brightline Coffee Co., its figures and this memo are fictional, made for testing the Intelligence Workbench. Market figures in section 2 are deliberately unverified.